

Timur Kayaalp

Monetary Policy • Inflation Expectations • Applied Econometrics

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EDUCATION

University College London (UCL) – MSc Economics

September 2025 – September 2026

Completed September 2026. Results expected November 2026, Merit expected.

Modules: Macroeconomics, Microeconomics, Econometrics, Time Series Econometrics, Macroeconomic Policy, Research Methods, International Trade, International Political Economy.

Dissertation: *Household Framing in Bank of England and Press Communication: Evidence from UK Inflation Expectations*, supervised by Professor Stephen Hansen.

University of Oxford – Economics Summer School (postgraduate level)

September 2025

Monetary Economics (New Keynesian model, financial frictions, central bank operations) and International Finance (international financial shocks, capital flows). Applied policy analysis in Python and MATLAB.

Koç University, Istanbul – BA Economics, *Magna Cum Laude*

September 2021 – June 2025

GPA 3.56/4.00. Track specialisations in Macroeconomic Policy & Financial Markets and in Finance, both 4.00/4.00. Dean's Honour List (2023), Vehbi Koç Honour Award (2024).

RESEARCH

Household Framing in Bank of England and Press Communication: Evidence from UK Inflation Expectations

MSc dissertation, University College London, supervised by Professor Stephen Hansen ([Link](#)) September 2026

- Studied how Bank of England monetary policy communication, and press coverage of it, affects UK household inflation expectations, testing whether the audience a message addresses (households or financial markets) matters more than its hawkish or dovish tone.
- Built a monthly dataset of 283 months and 88 variables (2003–2026) from the Office for National Statistics (ONS), the Bank of England (Bank Rate, implied inflation curve, Bank of England/Ipsos Inflation Attitudes Survey), London Stock Exchange Group (LSEG) market data and Reuters polls, and applied text analysis and natural language processing (NLP) to 312 Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) minutes, 95 Monetary Policy Reports and 6,625 newspaper articles.
- Identified monetary policy and communication shocks (Romer–Romer, sign restrictions, high-frequency event study) and estimated time-series impulse responses with local projections, in a reproducible Python pipeline.
- Found that household-framed press coverage lowers 12-month household inflation expectations by 0.35 percentage points while tone has no pooled effect, and that household framing reduces the share of households expecting inflation above 5% by 4.6 percentage points.

Research Assistant to Professor Selva Demiralp, Koç University

October 2024 – June 2025

Koç University Household Inflation Expectations Survey ([Link](#)) Istanbul

- Worked on a nationally representative monthly phone panel of about 2,800 households across more than 70 provinces, run with the polling firm KONDA. Results are published monthly and followed by policymakers and the press.
- Processed nine monthly waves of survey microdata (90 variables) in Stata, SPSS and Python, delivering a clean, weighted dataset for each monthly report.
- Converted free-text survey answers into numeric data (about 40% of inflation and income responses) and combined branching questions into a single 12-month inflation expectation measure.
- Applied survey weights and outlier trimming at three standard deviations, built per-capita household income and income quintiles, and linked respondents across waves by panel ID for matched-panel comparisons.

Evaluating the Impact of Sanctions: Russia's Economy and Global Trade Dynamics ([Link](#))

Independent policy paper

December 2024

- Assessed the effectiveness of 2022–2024 sanctions on Russia's natural-resource revenues, focusing on the EU crude-oil embargo and the G7 oil price cap.
- Evaluated macroeconomic outcomes and trade-offs, including the rouble, the Bank of Russia's policy-rate path from 9.5% to 21%, fiscal stimulus and the rerouting of energy exports to China, India and Türkiye.
- Proposed ways to strengthen price-cap enforcement, including regulation of shipping and insurance services to the “shadow fleet”, a lower cap and secondary-sanction enforcement.

EXPERIENCE

Ministry of Treasury and Finance of Türkiye – Intern, Market Risk Analysis

July 2024 – August 2024

Directorate General of Public Finance

Ankara

- Wrote a report on how Türkiye could build a direct retail platform for government securities modelled on the US

TreasuryDirect system, covering auction access, settlement and its role in public debt management. The report went to the Director General.

- Presented to the Deputy Director General on monetary and fiscal policy interdependence, using international examples.
- Analysed public debt statistics and sovereign financing indicators on Bloomberg Terminal.

QNB Bank – Intern, Corporate Banking (part-time)

February 2025 – March 2025
Istanbul

- Analysed corporate clients' balance sheets, income statements and cash flows in Excel, calculating leverage, liquidity and debt-service ratios used in credit assessment.
- Learned the corporate lending cycle, from client relationship and financial analysis to credit approval and monitoring, alongside relationship managers.

Anti-Corruption Policy Centre (Yabloko) – Research Programme Participant

July 2025 – August 2025

Money Laundering in the Crypto Era

Moscow (hybrid)

- Compared digital currency regulation and enforcement across financial jurisdictions and proposed design principles for a privacy-preserving, anti-money-laundering (AML) compliant and secure digital currency for developing countries, presented to party leadership.

Koç University – Student Tutor, Macroeconomics (ECON102, ECON202)

October 2024 – June 2025

- Tutored undergraduates one-to-one and in small groups on the Solow growth model, IS–LM and AD–AS, the Phillips curve, the Taylor rule and open-economy macroeconomics (Mundell–Fleming).

SKILLS

Programming and software: Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, matplotlib, Hugging Face Transformers, PyTorch, gensim), Stata, SPSS, Excel, Git, LaTeX, MATLAB (introductory)

Econometrics and methods: time series econometrics, local projections, monetary policy shock identification (Romer–Romer, sign restrictions, high-frequency event studies), survey microdata (weighting, panel data), text analysis and natural language processing (dictionaries, word embeddings, transformer classifiers), machine learning (LASSO, cross-validation), randomisation inference

Data platforms: LSEG Workspace (Refinitiv), Bloomberg Terminal, Nexis, ONS and Bank of England statistical databases

Certificates: Money Laundering in the Crypto Era (AML frameworks and digital currency regulation), Anti-Corruption Policy Centre (Yabloko), August 2025

Languages: Turkish (native), Russian (native), English (C1, IELTS 8.0), French (B1), Ukrainian (B1)

Tests: GRE Quantitative 167, Verbal 155 (January 2025)

RIGHT TO WORK

Graduate Route visa: eligible to work in the UK until January 2029, no sponsorship required.